

Did do you know the following about Manish Sharma?

- He has played cricket with several players who have represented India.
- He wanted to be a doctor or pursue a career in commerce. He took up engineering because of his best friend.
- His family went through a financial crisis when he was starting college.
- He quit his first job the day he joined.
- His biggest inspiration continues to be his mom.
- He lead Samsung's R&D team at the young age of 29.
- He does not know how to cook but loves to treat people with Japanese and Indian delicacies.

Manish's Career Chart

- He is currently Chairman & CEO, Panasonic India and South Asia
- August 2008: Joined Panasonic as head of marketing
- July 2004: Joined Haier Appliances as AGM in Consumer Electronics division
- February 2001: Joined Samsung as head of R&D, Colour Televisions
- January 1996: Joined LG Hotline
- He quit his first job, which was in a fibre-optic cable company, the day he joined

age. He learnt this and many other things from his father who worked in the Birla Group and his father's elder brother who was president and a director in Birla Group.

"When I was growing up, I had really good friends. I think a lot of people would be able to relate with me and agree that genuine friendships are made in the initial stages of your life. You tend to become more practical when you start growing up and you are then not able to do justice to deep rooting your relationships. The childhood friends are pretty deep rooted in your life, and so is the case with me," he recalls.

Manish completed his schooling from Carmel Convent School in Gwalior. A typical day for Manish would end by 8.00 PM, while the mornings used to be a little early. He is never late for meetings, events, or anything that he has committed time to.

"A typical day at school was full of action. You go to school, come back, finish your homework, and go out to play. The TVs were not there so we had a lot of physical activities on our hands. Weekends were filled with activities like picnics. That was a different era altogether as there was very low penetration of things like TVs and internet," he shares.

Manish has been fascinated with

the world of electronics since his school days. He remembers how electronics was a major inspiration for many in the city of Gwalior; many had heard about electronic goods but only a few had experienced them physically. Manish was so fascinated with electronics that he designed a lift for a school exhibition.

"I was very fond of seeing the repair guys seated in one corner of the showroom. One of the reasons for my fondness was magnets. When speakers get repaired, you get magnets out of them. I would use those magnets for a variety of purposes," he recalls as he walks down the memory lane.

Manish, in the process of growing up, has lost some friends, made new ones, and learned about life. The challenges he has faced in his early

schooling days include getting up at 4.30 in the morning and running to preparation classes for engineering colleges and universities. One of the finest skills that Manish has developed over time is how to resonate with others. When asked how one resonates with others, he answers, "It is a combination of natural talent and how you groom that talent. The same is true for leadership also."

He adds, "In my case I did not participate much in stage shows or debates during my schooling years. If I try to relate my life today with my school life, I would like to be on the stage to talk to people. People can develop skills over time. Some of these skills are already there, and these just need a trigger, others are learned over time."

Manish's uncle (father's elder brother) was president with the Birla Group. Manish spent a lot of time with his uncle and learnt a lot of leadership and relationship lessons from him. "He had a specific aura around him. I got several chances to spend a lot of time with him once he retired and started living in Delhi. I was able to relate a lot with his experiences of life," he says.

An avid reader, Manish has read loads of books, and is of the view that books can inspire people in many ways. Not a big fan of fiction, he enjoys reading autobiographies, books on philosophy and life the most. Manish also enjoys reading the work of Panasonic's founder

Konosuke Matsushita.

"When it comes to autobiographies, I think both the Steve Jobs autobiographies will inspire you a lot. The movie on Steve is good but I think it does not do justice to the challenges faced by the legend, whereas the book is much more detailed about the same. Then a basic



Manish Sharma at LG Hotline